Dear Kamie,

Happy Birthday, Kamie! ♥

As the hopeless romantic that I am, forgive me for the sheer length of this letter. 😭😂 I thought it wise and nice to do this because, as the saying goes, silver and gold have I none. 😅😒 I actually planned on ordering something for you, but unfortunately, that plan, amongst many others, was fucked up this year. Nevertheless, I do hope this vindicates me. 😅 Besides, I figured that if I couldn't give you something I ordered, I could at least give you something I made, something with a little more of myself in it. And well, here we are. I made you an entire website, so I suppose I've committed to the bit now. 😂

I wanted you to have something you could come back to, something that would remind you of this particular day and, hopefully, make you smile whenever you revisit it. Something that captures little pieces of you: the memories, the music, the ridiculous moments, and the things I might not always find the right words to say.

I still have our chats from the very beginning, even from AF before we moved to the DMs. Once in a while, I go back and ask myself, *How did I get here? How did I get infected with this hanc—sorry, hankersore?* 😭😂 And every time I do, I realise just how much I've calmed down concerning you. It's funny looking back at how things started and comparing it with where we are now. It's been a joy getting to know you, even though you have my stomach in knots sometimes. And it's going to be even more fun watching you grow. (You'll always still be a zygote to me. 🤨😅) Because you are, and are going to be, amazing. 💯

One of the things I appreciate about you is that there isn't just one version of you. There's the playful, mischievous girl who can be an absolute menace for no apparent reason, and then there's the other side, the one that makes me curious about what goes on in your head, how you see things, and all the little details that make you who you are. I wanted this gift to celebrate those different sides of you, because they're all part of the person I'm wishing a happy birthday to today.

Thank you for giving me an ear, for listening to my rants and vents, for being patient with me, for the laughs, the mischief, the spams, the conversations, the confusing messages, the one-word replies, the calls (even though we rarely speak on calls 😭), the reading sessions, the singing chronicles, listening to the songs I send you (at this point, they should officially be **OUR songs** 😊), and, of course, story time.

I appreciate all of it, genuinely. And I think there's something beautiful about all these little things we share. Every conversation, every song, every reading session, every random story, and every ridiculous exchange gives us another piece of each other's lives. They give us more things to remember, more things to laugh about, and more opportunities to understand each other beyond the surface. In their own little ways, these moments are helping us build something meaningful: a bond that grows through time, familiarity, trust, and the willingness to keep showing up for each other, even though we're far apart. I hope we never stop making room for those moments.

So, **Lawalesme Chisom Penelope** (I've forgotten the Esan one. Omoze-something, right? 😭😂), here's my prayer for you.
May your days be long, and may you walk in good and perfect health throughout this new year of your life and beyond. May you receive speedy answers to your heart's desires, and may God continue to keep and guide you in all that you do. May He replenish you with His excellent spirit, show Himself strong in your life, and give you the grace and strength to work out life as you walk with Him. May He also grant you the full package of Revelation 5:12 in Christ Jesus.

May He make your alto sweeter than ever, your beauty ever resplendent, and your aura comforting—or otherwise, as you deem fit. 😊😅
May He keep you, your family, and your loved ones in peace and in health, and take away sadness from all that concerns you. May He bless the work of your hands, order your steps, strengthen you when life gets difficult, and give you reasons to smile even in seasons when smiling doesn't come easily.

And for us, may He help us become more open with each other,

communicate better, understand each other more deeply, and be better friends this year and beyond. May we learn to navigate each other's differences with patience, honesty, and grace, and may whatever we continue to build be something we both cherish.... **IJN. Amen.** ♥

I hope this new year brings you reasons to laugh until your stomach hurts, opportunities that excite you, people who genuinely care about you, and moments that remind you how much good there is still waiting for you. I hope you find the courage to pursue the things you want, the patience to get through the things you don't, and the wisdom to recognise when you deserve a little rest.

And on the days when things don't go according to plan, I hope you're gentle with yourself. You don't have to have everything figured out. You don't have to be at your best every single day. You're allowed to grow at your own pace, change your mind, make mistakes, and discover new things about yourself along the way. I hope you never forget that becoming the person you want to be is a journey, not a race.

I really care about you, Kamie, and I'm genuinely grateful that Wednesday dragged your ass to Anime Family. 😭😅
Imagine if you hadn't shown up. Look at the amount of trouble I would've been spared—and the amount of joy I would've missed. I'm glad our paths crossed, and I'm grateful that I get to know you the way I do.

I hope we'll both put in the work to become better friends and, perhaps, even more. I want us to keep growing closer, to be more intentional about understanding each other, and to create even more memories worth looking back on. I don't expect everything to be perfect, but I do hope we keep choosing honesty, patience, and effort. Because whatever happens, nothing changes the fact that **I want you**. (Mineeeeeee 😭😅😍)

Thank you for being you, for the laughs, the conversations, the mischief, and the little moments that make knowing you what it is. I hope this gift gives you even a fraction of the happiness I felt putting it together.

So, Kamie, here's to another year of becoming, learning, laughing, singing,

reading, and living. May you have more beautiful memories to make, more dreams to chase, more songs to add to *our* playlist, and more reasons to be proud of the person you're becoming.

I love you, Pumpkin. 🧡

Happy Birthday once again, Kamie. I hope today reminds you that your existence is worth celebrating, not just because it's your birthday, but simply because you're here.

With love, prayers, and the occasional complaint about your troublesome behaviour,

Always,

Heiwa ♡